SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #46 · PROSPERITY AND BLESSING

“Wealth proves God is pleased with me.”

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Where it often comes from

When things go well, it is natural to give thanks. The danger is concluding that success is God’s stamp of approval. Teaching that links faithfulness with financial reward can lead us to read our bank balance as a spiritual report card, and to look down on those who have less.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one’s life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.” Paul tells the rich not to be conceited or to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God. Proverbs warns that he who trusts in his riches will fall. Jesus said it is easier for a camel to pass through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God. Wealth can be a gift, but it is not a sign of God’s favor.

> *“And He said to them, ‘Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one’s life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.’”* (Luke 12:15).

Also see

> “Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy” (1 Timothy 6:17).

> “Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to pass through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God” (Matthew 19:24).

> “He who trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous will thrive like foliage” (Proverbs 11:28).

> “Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’” (Hebrews 13:5).

Common self-statements

- God is blessing me because I am doing right.
- My success shows I am in His favor.
- People who struggle must be doing something wrong.
- I deserve what I have.
- If I lose this, God must be displeased.
- My wealth is my reward.

Common logical errors

- Just-world thinking: Believing that people always get what they deserve.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling blessed and concluding that wealth means approval.
- Halo effect: Assuming prosperity proves character.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing wealth as proof and poverty as failure.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that wealth means God’s approval?
- Do I know people who are faithful and not wealthy, or wealthy and not faithful?

- How did Jesus and the apostles live?
- What does Jesus say about trusting in riches?
- What would I conclude about God's pleasure if I lost my money?
- How can I hold wealth with thanks and openness?

Truth summary

> God is pleased with me because of Christ, not because of my balance. Wealth is a gift to steward and share, not a measure of His approval. I can give thanks without judging myself or others by money.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Riches, Beware of
- Riches, True
- Pride
- Humility
- Giving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Wealth proves God is pleased with me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Wealth proves God is pleased with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn wealth means approval?
- ☐ What do I trust in?
- ☐ What non-money blessings do I have?
- ☐ How do I view people with less?
- ☐ What could I share?
- ☐ What if I lost it all?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's approval does not come from wealth.
- ☐ Life is more than possessions.
- ☐ My hope is in God, not riches.
- ☐ Wealth is a gift to share.
- ☐ Others' struggles are not proof of their failure.
- ☐ I am pleasing to Him in Christ.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 12:15**
  "And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"
- ☐ **1 Timothy 6:17**
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy."
- ☐ **Proverbs 11:28**
  "He who trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous will thrive like foliage."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Gift, not grade: Each week, write one thing you have and how you can share or steward it.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 12:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My life does not consist of my possessions, so wealth is not proof of God's favor.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, Beware of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Examine the belief. Write where you learned that wealth equals blessing.
- [ ] List non-money blessings. Name ten gifts from God that are not financial.
- [ ] Share something. Give time, money, or help to someone this week.
- [ ] Pray 1 Timothy 6:17. Ask God to keep your hope in Him.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Wealth proves God is pleased with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A gift shared
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Wealth proves God is pleased with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for what You have given me. Keep me from reading my wealth as Your approval. Help me trust You, share generously, and love people regardless of what they have. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.